

loic

The **Low Orbit Ion Cannon (LOIC)** is an open-source network stress-testing and denial-of-service (DoS) application written in C#. [1]

Key Details About LOIC

- **Function:** It floods a target server with TCP, UDP, or HTTP requests to overwhelm its resources like CPU, memory, and bandwidth.
- **Origin:** Developed originally by Praetox Technologies in 2010 before being released into the public domain.
- **Notoriety:** Gained fame for use by the hacktivist group [Anonymous](#) and users on 4chan forums to launch coordinated attacks.
- **Usage:** While built for network stress testing, it is widely classified as a [DDoS attack tool](#) due to its frequent malicious use. [1, 2, 3, 4]

Would you like to know more about how **LOIC works technically**, or are you looking for information on **defending against DoS attacks**?

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Wikipedia

Low Orbit Ion Cannon - Wikipedia

Low Orbit Ion Cannon. Article · Talk. Language; Download PDF; Watch · Edit. "LOIC" redirects here. For other uses, see Loic (disam...



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LOIC performs a DoS attack by flooding the target with TCP, UDP, or HTTP requests. This can overwhelm the server's resources like ...



Cloudflare

What Is The Low Orbit Ion Cannon (LOIC)? - Cloudflare

What is the Low Orbit Ion Cannon (LOIC)? The Low Orbit Ion Cannon is a tool commonly used to launch DoS and DDoS attacks. It was o...

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what was it famously used on?

The **Low Orbit Ion Cannon (LOIC)** became globally famous through several high-profile coordinated cyberattacks launched by the hacktivist collective [Anonymous](#): [1]

1. Operation Payback (2010)

This is the campaign that brought LOIC into mainstream news prominence. Anonymous targeted major financial and legal institutions in retaliation for actions taken against digital freedom and the whistleblowing site WikiLeaks: [1, 2]

- **Visa, Mastercard, and PayPal:** Attacked using LOIC after they froze donation accounts and blocked processing payments to WikiLeaks.
- **The RIAA & MPAA:** The Recording Industry Association of America and Motion Picture Association of America were targeted to protest aggressive anti-piracy lawsuits and copyright laws. [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

2. Operation Megaupload (2012)

Following the federal shutdown of the popular file-hosting site Megaupload and the arrest of its founders, Anonymous launched what they claimed was their largest coordinated DDoS campaign at the time. Over 5,000 users deployed LOIC simultaneously to shut down: [1, 2]

- **The U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ)**
- **The Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI)**
- **The U.S. Copyright Office**
- **Universal Music Group** and various other record labels. [1, 2]

3. Project Chanology (2008)

This was one of the earliest widespread uses of LOIC. Anonymous launched a digital war against the **Church of Scientology** after the Church tried to legally scrub an embarrassing video of Tom Cruise from YouTube. Thousands of users deployed LOIC to successfully knock mainstream Scientology websites offline. [1, 2]

The Backlash for Users

Because LOIC simply floods servers without hiding the sender's origin, it does **not** anonymize the user. Consequently, these famous attacks led to law enforcement tracking down and arresting dozens of individual participants worldwide who had downloaded the tool thinking they were anonymous. [1, 2]

Would you like to explore **how law enforcement traced** LOIC users, or learn about its successor tool, **HOIC (High Orbit Ion Cannon)**?

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Low Orbit Ion Cannon - Wikipedia

Usage. A screenshot of LOWC (Low Orbit Web Cannon) running in a web browser. LOIC was used by Anonymous (a group that spawned from...



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Myra Security

Low orbit ion cannon: definition, how it works - Myra Security

Beginning in September 2010, Anonymous conducted multiple DDoS attacks against the websites of financial institutions, industry as...



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Notable LOIC Attack Instances and Events LOIC has been used in many high-profile cyberattacks, including: Krebs on Security DDoS (



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I (Tom Klootwijk NL200678942 10-07-1990) actually participated in 1. but not 2. back in my day 2010 is 2020 hindsight as they say (Elizabeth 2020 COVID diariama)

It is fascinating to hear firsthand from someone who was around during that specific era of internet history. Operation Payback in 2010 was a massive turning point for how the public viewed digital activism and cybersecurity, and looking back on it now certainly offers a lot of perspective.

If you are interested in looking back at how those events shaped the digital landscape, we could look into how cyber laws changed after 2010, or discuss how network security evolved to defend against tools like LOIC. What aspect of that history interests you the most today?

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no unpack the punitive pun

The phrase "**2010 is 2020 hindsight**" packs a punchy double meaning, blending a classic idiom with the chaos of recent history. Here is how that punitive pun unpacks:

- **The Vision Pun:** "20/20 vision" means perfect sight. "Hindsight is 20/20" means it is easy to see the right choice *after* the event. By swapping 20/20 for the year

2010, it highlights looking back at the choices made during Operation Payback with perfect clarity today.

- **The Timeline Pun:** It links the year **2010** (the chaotic era of LOIC and Anonymous) directly to the year **2020** (the start of the COVID-19 pandemic and lockdowns).

Your mention of the "**Elizabeth 2020 COVID diariama**" frames 2020 as a bizarre, historical spectacle—a miniature, staged drama (diorama) of isolation, rules, and reflection. Looking back from the vantage point of the pandemic era makes the digital rebellion of 2010 look like a completely different world.

Would you like to explore more about how the **cultural memory of 2010** compares to the **digital shift during 2020**, or dive into another **pun** from that era?